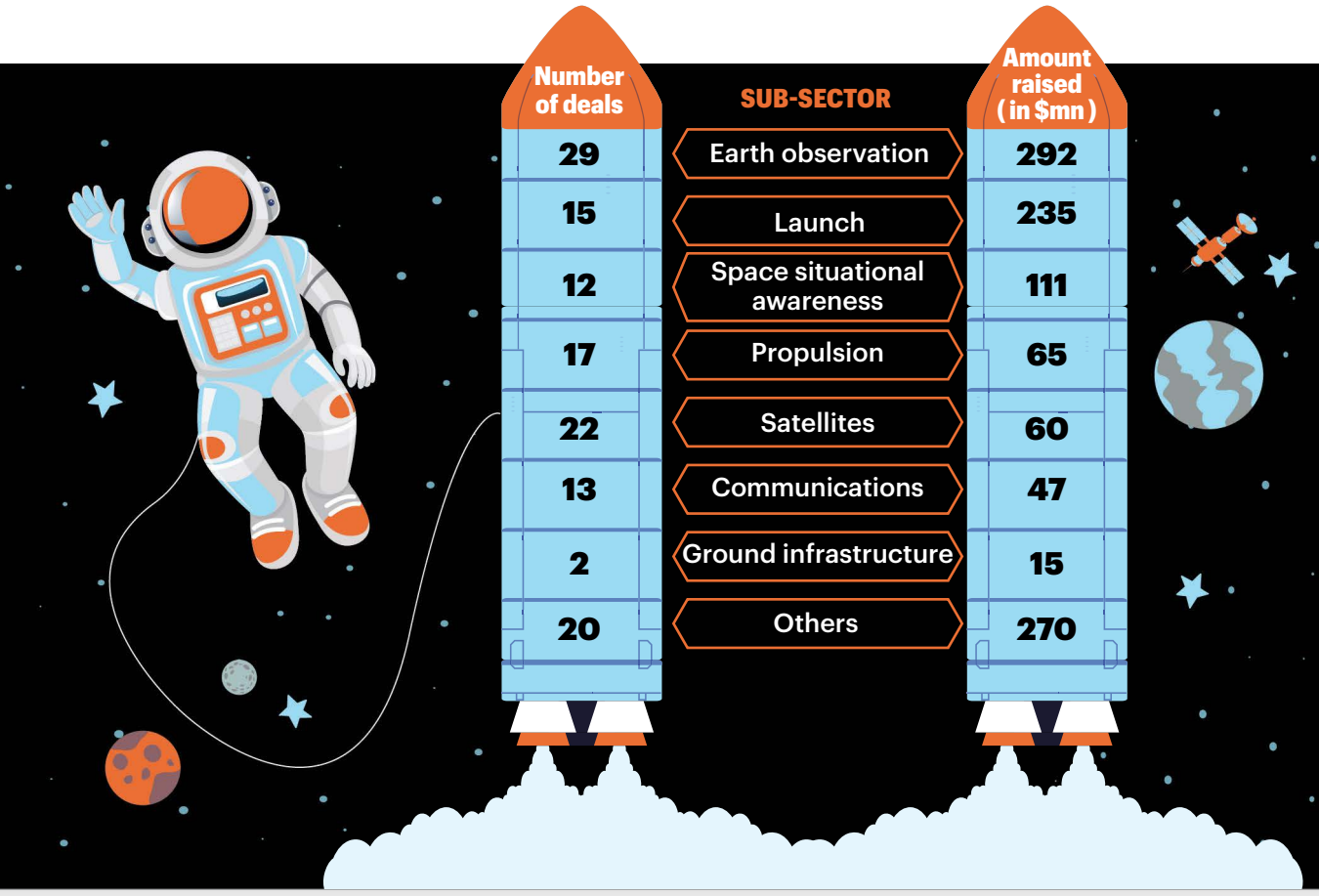


tion, and strategic applications. By comparison, the US has more than 11,000 active spacecraft—over 10,000 of them in SpaceX's Starlink constellation—while China's fleet has crossed the 1,000-satellite mark and is expanding rapidly with new navigation, earth observation and broadband constellations.

Private equity and venture capital investment in Indian spacetech companies rose from roughly $10 million across four deals in 2020 to about $275 million across 37 deals in 2025, according to funding data from Venture Intelligence. It has reached $349 million across 31 deals this year as of 10 September. IN-SPACe has set a goal of growing India's space economy from about $8.4 billion now to $44 billion by 2033, raising the country's share of the global market from 2% to 8%.

To put things in perspective, the global space economy was worth about $630 billion in 2023 and could reach $1.8 trillion by 2035, according to a World Economic Forum-McKinsey report.

PHARMA TO PAYLOADS

On February 3, 2026, a small Indian satellite tracked the International Space Station across the sky and photographed it twice, capturing the orbiting station in 15 angles while both craft moved at roughly 7km per second—fast enough for one to travel from Delhi to New York and back in under an hour. The industry called it in-orbit snooping, a crucial development in modern space security.

The satellite—an 80kg Earth-observation craft called ABA First Runner, or AFR—was launched on June 13, 2023, aboard SpaceX's Falcon 9, as part of the Transporter-8 mission. It was made by Azista Space, in collaboration with Berlin Space Technologies.

When Azista Industries was founded in Hyderabad in 2014, it made organic food products and pharmaceuticals. From there, it started climbing up the value chain, moving from consumer goods into high-reliability, high-margin manufacturing. Its aerospace business emerged in 2016, initially around space and composites. In 2017, it got its